NAP
Nobulous Apprenticeship Program

A prestigious opportunity. Terms and conditions apply.

One Apprentice, three Time Slots a day, and a workload that does not care how tired you are. Earn Credits across four subjects, survive the things that go wrong, and pass a Final Exam built out of everything you neglected.

COMPONENTS

- 6 Apprentice cards
- 26 Task cards (double-sided: Request / Demand)
- 6 Setback cards
- 6 Opportunity cards
- 12 Final Exam cards (3 per subject)
- 1 FINF track card, 1 Time Slot dial
- **From 20 Strong:** the 17 unit dice — 4 Purple, 4 Blue, 4 Green, 4 Yellow, 1 Red
- **From 20 Strong:** the 3 stat dice — Health, Strategy and Recovery — and the Chip

SETUP

1. Choose an Apprentice. All six begin at **2 HP / 2 STR / 2 REC**; they differ only in abilities.
2. Shuffle 3 of the 6 Setbacks into the 26 Tasks and 6 Opportunities to form the Assignment deck. Return the other 3 Setbacks to the box.
3. Set the FINF track to **−1** (Standard difficulty).
4. Separate the 12 Final Exams. You will build the exam pool later.
5. Take all 17 dice as available. Set the Time Slot dial to Morning, Day 1.

OBJECT OF THE GAME

Earn **6 Credits** to reach the Final Exam, then survive three exams with at least 1 Health remaining. Credits are earned by completing Credit Tasks and are never spent — a completed Task stays face-up as the record of that subject.

THE DAY

Each day has three Time Slots: **Morning**, **Afternoon**, **Evening**. Each slot runs:

1. Perform the recovery shown on the dial for this slot. (Day 1 Morning has no special recovery.)
2. Reveal 2 Assignments and select one as your **Primary**. A Setback among them **must** be taken. The Primary's recovery-colour dot sets the colour queued for the next Time Slot.
3. Work Assignments with Strategy rolls.
4. Exhaust non-stored committed dice. Perform **Special Recovery**, then normal recovery by REC. Set the dial to the Primary's dot and advance.

After Evening, resolve End of Day.

> **SPECIAL RECOVERY**
>
> Recover **all** exhausted dice of the queued recovery colour. Then recover dice equal to your REC separately. Choosing which card becomes Primary is therefore choosing which colour you get back in bulk next slot.

STR in NAP

STR does two jobs and resets every Time Slot. It is the number of Strategy rolls available in the slot, *and* the maximum number of Assignments you may complete in that slot — even if more have enough successes on them.

WORKING ASSIGNMENTS

- You may spread dice across as many Assignments as you like during a roll.
- **Every roll must be a real attempt.** Choose at least one Assignment (a Setback if one is present) and commit either one die matching that Assignment's colour dot, or at least two dice of another colour. Empty rolls are illegal.

- An Assignment is completed with a successful die matching its colour dot, with Red as wild, or with two successful dice of the same other colour.
- You may spend 1 STR to remove the initial Assignment without gaining its benefit.
- A Time Slot holds a maximum of **4** Assignments.

Unresolved Assignments

- An Assignment you do not finish flips to its **Demand** side — higher Target — and stays in the row. Its printed Demand penalty applies from then on.
- Successful dice on an unresolved Assignment may be **stored as progress** instead of exhausted.
- Once the next Time Slot begins, stored dice are locked to that Assignment and cannot be voluntarily exhausted.
- When an Assignment finally resolves, its committed and stored dice exhaust unless the card says otherwise.

Assignment types

TYPE	ROLE
Task	The only source of Credits.
Setback	Mandatory and disruptive. No Credits.
Opportunity	Optional and beneficial. No Credits, no penalties.

> **SKULLS**
>
> Skulls resolve only on Assignments *you chose*. Ignore Skulls on cards added by another Skull, by FINF, or by a forced replacement. If a Skull would add an Assignment while the slot already holds 4, do not add a card — instead rotate the Skull-generating Assignment to its Demand side once. Further blocked Skulls do nothing.

END OF DAY

Reveal and discard the top card of the Assignment deck. Ignore all of its text, effects and Skulls. The apprenticeship is finite: work you never took is work that disappears.

THE FINAL EXAM

Leaving the apprenticeship

Discard unresolved Assignments and exhaust their stored dice. If you have fewer than 6 Credits, exhaust 1 available die per missing Credit in the order Red, Purple, Blue, Green, Yellow, looping as needed.

Preparation

- Recover 1 exhausted die.
- Recover 1 further exhausted die per Credit *above* 6. Excess-Credit recovery may not pick the same colour twice.
- Perform the queued Morning recovery.

Building the exam pool

For each subject independently, place cards from that subject into the pool:

CREDITS IN SUBJECT	CARDS PLACED
0–1	1
2–3	2
4+	3

Shuffle the pool and draw **3** Final Exams. Neglected subjects are thinly represented but brutal when they appear; studied subjects show up often and are easy.

Resolving the exams

1. Reduce the exam's base Target by 1 for each Credit you hold in that subject.
2. Roll against the modified Target, honouring the exam's printed restriction.
3. **Lose 1 Health for each success below the modified Target.** If you still have Health, you passed.
4. Perform Special Recovery using that exam card's own colour dot, then resolve the next exam.

All three exams are mandatory. FINF is not used during the Final Exam. Finish all three with at least 1 Health to win NAP.

CARRYING NAP FORWARD

Only relevant if you are playing the NRJ campaign.

The **3 Final Exams you actually faced** are retained. Three unused Final Exams become candidates. NAP contributes 6 cards to the Research Pool. Which exams you faced is a direct record of which subjects you studied.